CLASS 8 — ENGLISH GULMOHAR · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 3

Chapter 14: **The Elephant and the Tragopan** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The poem suggests that development and wildlife conservation: 1

(a) can never be combined
(b) are the same
(c) should be balanced through careful planning
(d) are irrelevant

2. A student argues that the poem is anti-development. A fair reply is that it: 1

(a) prefers cities
(b) praises reservoirs
(c) rejects all roads
(d) criticises careless development that ignores other lives

3. The poet's attitude to human beings is: 1

(a) totally hostile **(b)** fully admiring
(c) critical but not hateful **(d)** indifferent

4. What is the effect of using animals to criticise human behaviour? 1

(a) It makes humans look good
(b) It removes meaning
(c) It lets the criticism sound gentle and fresh
(d) It hides the message

5. Which modern situation resembles the poem's main idea? 1

(a) planting a school garden **(b)** opening a library
(c) repairing a bridge **(d)** clearing a forest to build a highway

6. Which of these devices is used when the elephant speaks like a person? 1

(a) pun **(b)** hyperbole **(c)** simile **(d)** personification

7. The poem would lose force if the trout were removed because: 1

(a) the elephant would stop speaking
(b) the forest would grow back
(c) the irony of short-sighted joy would vanish
(d) the road would disappear

8. The shift from the trout's joy to the elephant's warning creates: 1

(a) alliteration **(b)** contrast **(c)** rhyme **(d)** repetition

9. The elephant's warning that all the animals will lose their homes suggests: 1

(a) human triumph **(b)** shared fate of all creatures
(c) punishment for animals **(d)** a happy ending

10. Which is the best description of the poem's structure? 1

(a) a letter
(b) a diary entry
(c) a list of facts
(d) a conversation among animals followed by a warning

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. What does the poem tell us about the responsibility of power? 2

12. How does the poem link roads and forests? 2

13. Rewrite in the passive: 'The reservoir will destroy the bamboo.' 2

14. Link the poem to a real-life environmental issue. 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Why does the poem not name villains? 3

16. Does the poem blame humans entirely? Argue. 3

17. Suggest three alternatives to destroying a forest for a road. 3

OR

How does the poem encourage empathy for animals? 3

18. How does the poem reflect 'think globally, act locally'? 3

OR

Describe how the structure of the poem moves from observation to warning. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Explain how the poem presents three different attitudes: the elephant's, the tragopan's and the trout's. 5

OR

How does Vikram Seth turn a serious environmental issue into effective poetry? 5

20. Compare the message of this poem and 'Saving the Gharial'. 5

OR

Rewrite the story of the poem as a short prose narrative (about 100 words) from the elephant's point of view. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — Total: 40 Marks